Question:

A 6-year-old girl is brought to the emergency department because of right elbow swelling and pain 30 minutes after falling onto her outstretched right arm. She has been unable to move her right elbow since the fall. Physical examination shows bruising, swelling, and tenderness of the right elbow; range of motion is limited by pain. An x-ray of the right arm shows a supracondylar fracture of the humerus with anterior displacement of the proximal fragment. Further evaluation is most likely to show which of the following findings?Answer Choices:A. Absent distal radial pulseB. Radial deviation of the wristC. Inability to abduct shoulderD. Inability to flex the elbow

Reasoning + Answer:

<think> To answer this question , we need to look at the symptoms and the results of the x-ray . The girl is experiencing swelling and pain in her right elbow after a fall , and the x-ray shows a supracondylar fracture of the humerus with anterior displacement of the proximal fragment . This type of fracture is a common type of break that can occur in the elbow , and it is often associated with a decreased range of motion in the elbow . The most likely finding in this case is a limitation in the girl's ability to move her elbow , which is consistent with the symptoms and the x-ray results . The absent distal radial pulse is more likely to be associated with a different type of injury , such as a fracture of the forearm . The radial deviation of the wrist is not a typical symptom of a supracondylar fracture of the humerus . The inability to abduct the shoulder is not directly related to the type of fracture described . Therefore , based on the likely cause of the girl's symptoms and the x-ray results , it is most likely that further evaluation will show an inability to flex the elbow.</think><answer>Inability to flex the elbow</answer>